Northwind Robotics - Employee Handbook

1. Welcome

Northwind Robotics designs warehouse robots for medium-sized logistics companies. The company was founded in 2014 in Gothenburg and today employs around 260 people across offices in Gothenburg, Tampere and Rotterdam.

This handbook describes the rules and benefits that apply to all permanent employees. Consultants and interns follow separate agreements. If anything in this handbook conflicts with your employment contract, the contract applies.

Questions about the handbook should be sent to the People team at people@northwind.example. The handbook is reviewed every year in January.

2. Working hours

Normal working time is 38.5 hours per week. Core hours are 09:30 to 15:00, Monday to Thursday. On Fridays core hours end at 13:00. Outside core hours employees plan their own time together with their team.

Overtime must be approved in advance by your manager. Approved overtime is compensated either with pay at 150 percent of the hourly rate or with time off, at a rate of 1.5 hours off for every hour worked.

3. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. At least two days per week must be spent at one of the company offices, so that teams can meet in person. Teams may agree on fixed office days.

Working from another country than your contract country is allowed for at most 20 working days per calendar year, and requires written approval from the People team because of tax and insurance rules.

The company pays a one-time home office allowance of 400 euros for a desk chair, screen or other equipment.

4. Vacation

All permanent employees have 28 vacation days per year. Employees who are 40 or older receive two extra days. Vacation is earned from 1 April to 31 March.

At least 15 days must be taken during the summer period, June to August. Up to 5 unused days may be saved to the next year; days beyond that are lost unless your manager has approved otherwise in writing.

5. Parental leave

Northwind tops up the national parental benefit so that employees on parental leave receive 90 percent of their salary for up to 180 days. The top-up applies to employees who have worked at the company for at least 12 months.

Employees returning from parental leave may work 80 percent of full time for the first three months back, with full salary.

6. Equipment

Every employee receives a laptop, which is replaced every three years. Developers may choose between Linux and macOS; all other roles use Windows.

Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to IT within 24 hours. Company equipment may not be used by family members or friends.

7. Expenses and travel

Receipts for business expenses must be submitted in the expense system within 30 days of the purchase. Expenses submitted later than that are only reimbursed after approval from the finance team.

When travelling for work, meals are reimbursed with up to 45 euros per day. Train is preferred over flights for trips shorter than five hours. Business class is not allowed, regardless of the length of the trip.

Hotels should be booked through the company travel agency. The maximum price per night is 160 euros, or 220 euros in London, Paris and Zurich.

8. Information security

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must not be reused between services. Multi-factor authentication is required for email, the code repositories and the expense system.

Customer data may never be copied to personal devices or private cloud storage. Suspected security incidents must be reported to security@northwind.example immediately, also outside office hours.

9. Leaving the company

The notice period is two months for the employee during the first two years of employment, and three months after that. All company equipment, including access cards, must be returned within five working days after the last day of employment.

Employees who leave are offered an exit interview with the People team. Participation is voluntary.